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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025
Third SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEFTQ201 - FOOD SAFETY STANDARDS AND CERTIFICATION (2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)
Duration: 2 HoursMaximum Marks: 70
Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap) Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.
Part A
Short Answer Questions Answer any 10 questions Each question carries 2 marks

1. **Who supervises Food Safety Officers at the district level? [U] / [CO2]**

At the district level, Food Safety Officers (FSOs) are generally supervised by the Designated Officer (DO) under the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) framework

2. **Explain the importance of FSSAI regulations in maintaining packaging quality. [K] / [CO3]**

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) plays a crucial role in ensuring that food packaging maintains quality, safety, and hygiene. Packaging is not just about appearance—it directly affects the safety, shelf life, and integrity of food products. Here's an explanation of the importance of FSSAI regulations in maintaining packaging quality:

3. What is the primary objective of FSSAI ?] [U] / [CO2]The primary objective of the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) is to ensure the availability of safe and wholesome food for human consumption in India.

4. What kind of threats does VACCP address? [K] / [CO1, CO5]

VACCP stands for Vulnerability Assessment and Critical Control Points.
It is a food safety management system that focuses on identifying and controlling vulnerabilities in the food supply chain related to food fraud**.**

5. Name two food products that require compulsory AGMARK certification] [U] / [CO3]The two food products that require compulsory AGMARK certification as mandated by the Food Safety and Standards Regulations are blended edible vegetable oil and fat spread.

6. What is the role of the NCCP in disseminating Codex information domestically?] [U] / [CO1]

The National Codex Contact Point (NCCP) plays a central role in disseminating Codex information domestically by serving as the official communication hub between the international Codex Secretariat and national stakeholders.

7. Explain how inadequate traceability affects consumer confidence and food safety. [K] / [CO3]Inadequate food traceability erodes consumer confidence and poses food safety risks by making it difficult to track and recall contaminated products, identify the source of fraud or adulteration, and verify a product's origin or quality claims.

8. What is the relationship between ISO and the WTO?[K] / [CO1]The International Organization for Standardization (ISO) and the World Trade Organization (WTO) have a collaborative relationship focused on promoting international trade and standardization.

9. What is the importance of GAP ? [U] / [CO1, CO5]

The importance of "GAP" depends on the context: Good Agricultural Practices (GAP) are important for ensuring food safety, promoting worker well-being, and improving environmental sustainability.

10. Describe two major functions of a Designated Officer under the FSS Act. . [K] / [CO2]A Designated Officer under the Food Safety and Standards (FSS) Act has two major functions:

1. Enforcement of Food Safety Standards 2. Handling Food Safety Violations

11. What do you mean by corrective action in the context of HACCP ?[U] / [CO1, CO5] HACCP (Hazard Analysis Critical Control Points), a corrective action is a pre-defined procedure to address a "deviation"—a failure to meet a critical limit at a critical control point (CCP)

12. Explain the necessity of regular cleaning and sanitation schedules in food processing units.] [U] / [CO3]

Regular cleaning and sanitation schedules are essential in food processing units to ensure food safety, maintain quality, and comply with regulations.**[2x10 = 20]**

Part B

Short Essay Questions Answer any 6 questions Each question carries 5 marks

13. Describe the role of HACCP in ISO 22000 implementation using a specific case study.. [U] / [CO1]In ISO 22000, HACCP is a core operational component and a foundational methodology integrated into a broader, systematic food safety management system (FSMS). While HACCP provides the specific tools for identifying and controlling hazards at critical points within a process

14. What is the role of the Adjudicating Officer in food safety cases?[K] / [CO2]

Under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006 (FSS Act) in India, the role of the Adjudicating Officer (AO) is a critical enforcement-level function**.**

15. Examine the role of voluntary certifications in reducing food fraud and mislabelling. [U] / [CO3]

Voluntary certification schemes can play a meaningful role in reducing food fraud and mis-labelling, though they are neither a silver bullet nor a substitute for regulatory enforcement.

1. Improving traceability, transparency and oversight,2. Aligning incentives & reputational risk,3. Standardising procedures and audits

16. What is the organizational structure of FSSAI? [K] / [CO2]The structure of the organization is illustrated clearly, including its chairperson, regional offices, advisory committees, scientific panels, and the hierarchy extending to state food safety officers

17. Discuss the purpose of the Threat Assessment and Critical Control Points (TACCP) system] [U] / [CO1, CO5]TACCP aims to identify and manage potential threats in food

safety through risk assessment and critical control points. Main components include understanding threats, implementing control measures, and ensuring continuous monitoring for enhanced food safety standards.

18. How do Codex standards influence national food control systems? [K] / [CO1]Codex standards play a crucial role in shaping national food control systems by providing a framework for food safety, quality, and fair trade practices.

19. Explain the importance of HACCP-based Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)] [U] / [CO1, CO5]

HACCP-based Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) are essential components of any effective food safety management system. They combine the principles of Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points (HACCP) with standardized operational procedures to ensure consistent control of food safety hazards throughout production, preparation, and service.

20. Discuss the principles of efficient writing for an SOP.[U] / [CO1, CO5]

Efficient writing for a Statement of Purpose (SOP) involves clarity, conciseness, and a strong narrative.
Understand Your Audience,Clear Structure,Concise Language

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

Long Essay Questions Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 10 marks

21. Explain the importance of proper documentation in the FSSAI licensing and registration process. [A] / [CO3]Proper documentation is crucial in the FSSAI licensing and registration process as it ensures compliance with food safety regulations and facilitates smoother approvals.

Regulatory Compliance, Streamlined Approval Process, Traceability and Accountability
Consumer Trust, Risk Management

22. Describe the structure, functions, and powers of the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI).[U] / [CO3]The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) is a statutory body responsible for regulating food safety and standards in India. It operates under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.

Structure:

- Establishment: FSSAI was established in 2006 under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006.
- Headquarters: Located in New Delhi.
- Leadership: Led by a Chairperson, appointed by the central government, along with a team of members from various fields, including food science, public health, and law.
- Regional Offices: FSSAI has several regional offices across India to facilitate its operations.

Functions:

- Regulation, Enforcement, Standards Setting

FSSAI plays a crucial role in ensuring the safety and quality of food in India, thereby protecting public health.

23. Analyze the impact of Codex standards on national food control systems and public health policies. [K] / [CO1]

Harmonization**,** Consumer Protection, Scientific Basis, Capacity Building**,**Trade Facilitation,Public Health Improvement,Legal Framework Support.

24. Discuss at least five essential personal hygiene practices that all food workers must follow to prevent contaminating food. [U] / [CO1]

Food workers must adhere to essential personal hygiene practices to prevent food contamination. Here are five key practices:

1. Handwashing 2. Clean Clothing 3. Personal Grooming 4. Avoiding Illness

5. Proper Use of Gloves. These practices are crucial for maintaining food safety and protecting public health.

[10x2 = 20]